

WORKSHOP ACTIVITY

Designing an LMS Prototype

A hands-on UI design activity for students using Canva, Google Stitch, Figma, or any design tool of your choice.

1. Overview

In this workshop, you will step into the role of a UI/UX designer hired to create a prototype for a brand-new Learning Management System (LMS) — a digital platform where students access courses, track progress, complete assignments, and communicate with instructors.

You will design a set of key screens for this LMS using a design tool such as Canva, Google Stitch, Figma, or Adobe XD. By the end of the session, you should have a clickable or visual prototype that clearly communicates how a student would navigate and use the platform.

2. Learning Objectives

- Apply core UI design principles (layout, hierarchy, color, typography, spacing) to a real-world product.
- Practice translating user needs into functional screen designs.
- Build a multi-screen prototype that tells a coherent user story.
- Give and receive constructive design feedback from peers.

3. Scenario

A local university, “Riverbend University,” wants to replace its outdated LMS with a fresh, student-friendly platform. The university has hired your design team to produce an initial visual prototype before development begins.

The university has shared the following requirements from student surveys:

- Students find current course pages confusing and want a cleaner way to track progress.
- Students want to see deadlines and announcements at a glance.
- Students often take quizzes on mobile devices and want distraction-free assessment screens.
- Students want an easy way to manage their profile and notification settings.

Your task is to design a prototype that responds to these needs.

4. Tools Required

- A laptop, tablet, or desktop computer with internet access.
- An account on your chosen design tool: Canva, Google Stitch, Figma, Adobe XD, or similar.
- (Optional) A notebook or template for sketching rough layouts before designing digitally.

5. Duration

Total time: approximately 2 hours 30 minutes

Time	Activity
0:00 – 0:15	Introduction to the scenario and brief
0:15 – 0:30	Explore the chosen design tool and existing LMS examples for inspiration
0:30 – 1:30	Design the five required screens
1:30 – 1:50	Add finishing touches: consistent colors, fonts, icons, and spacing
1:50 – 2:10	Peer review: swap prototypes with a partner and note feedback
2:10 – 2:30	Refine designs based on feedback and prepare for presentation

6. Screens to Design

Your prototype must include the following five screens, connected in a logical flow (e.g., Login leads to Dashboard, Dashboard leads to Course Content, and so on):

#	Screen	Must Include
1	Login / Sign-Up	Fields for email & password, a primary action button, a link for account recovery, and a way to switch between student/instructor roles.
2	Student Dashboard	A welcome area, a snapshot of enrolled courses with progress indicators, and quick links to upcoming deadlines or announcements.
3	Course Content Page	A list or module view of lessons/units, clear indication of completed vs. pending items, and a visible way to resume learning.
4	Quiz / Assessment Screen	Question display area, answer options, a progress or timer indicator, and clear submit/next navigation.
5	Profile / Settings Page	Editable user details, a notifications or preferences section, and a logout action.

7. Activity Instructions

Step 1 — Plan

1. Sketch a rough layout of each screen on paper or a digital notepad before opening your design tool.
2. Decide on a simple color palette (2–3 main colors) and a font pairing (one for headings, one for body text).
3. List the navigation elements that will appear on most screens, such as a top bar or side menu.

Step 2 — Design

4. Open your chosen design tool and create a new project sized for either desktop or mobile view (choose one and stay consistent).
5. Build each of the five required screens listed in Section 6.
6. Apply your color palette, fonts, and spacing consistently across all screens.
7. Use placeholder text and icons where real content is not available (e.g., “Introduction to Biology” as a sample course name).

Step 3 — Connect

8. If your tool supports it, link your screens together so a viewer can click through the prototype in order (Login → Dashboard → Course → Quiz → Profile).
9. If linking is not possible, arrange the screens side by side in the order a student would experience them.

Step 4 — Review

10. Exchange your prototype with a partner or small group.
11. Note down two things that work well and two suggestions for improvement, using the rubric in Section 8 as a guide.
12. Spend 15–20 minutes refining your design based on the feedback you received.

8. Evaluation Rubric

Criterion	Weight	What Graders Look For
Navigation & Information Architecture	20%	Menus, dashboards, and course structure are logically organized and easy to follow.
Visual Hierarchy & Layout	20%	Clear grouping, spacing, and emphasis guide the eye to the most important actions on each screen.
Consistency	15%	Colors, fonts, buttons, and icons are used the same way across every screen.
Accessibility & Readability	15%	Sufficient color contrast, legible font sizes, and clear labels for all interactive elements.
Completeness of Screens	15%	All five required screens are present and fulfill their stated purpose.
Creativity & Branding	15%	The prototype has a distinct visual identity appropriate for an educational product.

9. Deliverables

- A shareable link or exported file (PDF/PNG) of your completed LMS prototype.
- A short written statement (3–5 sentences) explaining the design decisions you made and why.
- Your peer feedback notes from Step 4.

10. Submission Guidelines

- Rename your file or link title as: LastName_FirstName_LMS_Prototype
- Submit through the class portal or as instructed by your facilitator.
- Late submissions should follow your course's standard late-work policy.

End of workshop brief — good luck, and enjoy designing!